

THE ARCHITECTURE OF UNWINDING

Photograph by VIVEK EADARA

For these five architects comfort isn't one size fits all. The design of relaxation begins with understanding what ease means to the people who'll be living in it and the conditions of the particular site where the home sits

By SMITA PATIL

In a world of constant motion, the definition of home has evolved into a vital sanctuary requiring a deliberate, poetic choreography of light and materiality. Leading architects are answering this demand for restorative spaces through a return to tactile honesty and context-driven design.

For Sham Salim, the co-founder of Calicut-based Aslam Sham Architects, nature is the best thing to put one's mind at ease. "I always feel that if you are surrounded by greens, if there's natural light coming in and if you can actually feel the breeze passing through, all of that subconsciously affects your mental well being positively, " says Salim. " You feel much calmer when you are at one with nature. So the starting point for us, whether we are designing a home or a resort or an office, is always about how can we make this space feel connected with the nature that surrounds it." At Lilly, a 7,600 sq ft residence the studio designed in Calicut, the spaces seem to float